Creative Intelligence System

A neutral intelligence layer for marketing measurement — strategy brief

The problem

Marketers drown in measurement, not data. Attention vendors, attribution platforms, brand trackers, creative-testing tools, and data warehouses each over-elevate the one metric they sell, so teams optimize toward the loudest number rather than what is actually working. Only **32% of marketers** measure across both digital and traditional channels (Nielsen, 2025), and privacy changes have cut attribution identity coverage from ~90% to **30–60%**. Every signal is now a partial, unreliable view of reality.

The product

CIS connects to the tools that already generate signals, normalizes their native metrics onto one common 0–100 scale across five domains — **Context, Attention, Creative, Behavioral, Business** — and synthesizes them, funnel-style, into a single explainable recommendation: **Scale, Optimize, Test, or Stop**. It finds the bottleneck in the chain rather than crowning one winning metric. It replaces nothing; it integrates everything.

> ### Why it's defensible — the moat
>
> The synthesis logic is a few hundred lines and easy to copy. The moat is the **connector + normalization layer**: live, maintained integrations into a dozen measurement platforms — each with its own API, auth, schema, and quirks — plus the calibration that makes Adelaide's "AU index" and System1's star rating comparable and confidence-weighted. Learn those weights from outcomes instead of hand-setting them, and the data advantage compounds. **Whoever owns the translation owns the category.**

The market

$2.3B → $6.2B MTA software, 2026→2033 (15% CAGR)	**Single → Multi** industry shift to reconciling several models	**0** incumbents own the neutral synthesis layer

The industry is moving from single-method measurement to running several models and reconciling them — exactly CIS's thesis. Incumbents own slices (MMM: Recast, Keen, Measured; attention: Adelaide, Lumen; intelligence: HockeyStack, Factors); none own the neutral layer above them.

Beachhead: agencies, not brands

Agencies already hold credentials to these tools across many clients, feel the fragmentation daily, and need cross-client comparability. They offer multiple campaigns per logo (proving the portfolio view), existing integrations to learn calibration from, and a path into brand-direct later. **Land agencies; expand to in-house CMO teams.**

Why now

Privacy-driven fragmentation has made any single source unreliable, forcing multi-method reconciliation — but no one has productized the neutral layer that does it. The window is the gap between "everyone runs five tools" (true today) and "someone owns the layer above them" (still open).

Key risks

- Connector upkeep is real engineering plus partner relationships, not a weekend project.
- Normalization is subjective; bad calibration erodes trust fast — recommendations must stay explainable (they are, by design).
- "Integrate everything" needs customers who already own several tools — a narrow, sophisticated buyer.
- Model drift: recommendations stale as feeds age and methods change — requires continuous recalibration.

Recommended next steps

1. Validate demand with 5 agency measurement leads — do they already run reconciliation by hand?
2. Sign 1–2 design partners; instrument one client's full stack end-to-end via the connector layer.
3. Fit calibration weights from their historical outcomes — turn the prototype's hand-set weights into learned ones.

Accompanies the interactive CIS prototype (connectors · normalization · synthesis · portfolio). Market figures: Nielsen 2025; Persistence Market Research; industry reporting, 2026.